African Parks.

But I didn't tell her the other reason: We couldn't risk being seen together, the press finding out about us. Not yet.

So, she finished her *Eat Pray Love* thing, then flew from London to Johannesburg, then to Maun, where I'd asked Teej to meet her. (I wanted to do it myself, of course, but couldn't without creating a scene.) After an eleven-hour odyssey, including a three-hour layover in Johannesburg, and a hot car ride to the house, Meghan had every right to be grumpy. But she wasn't. Bright-eyed, eager, she was ready for anything.

And looking like…perfection. She wore cut-off jean shorts, well-loved hiking boots, a crumpled Panama hat that I'd seen on her Instagram page.

As I opened the gate to Teej and Mike's house, I handed her a chicken-salad sandwich, wrapped in clingfilm. *Thought you might be hungry*. I suddenly wished I had flowers, a present, something besides this measly sandwich. We hugged, and it was awkward, not just because of the sandwich but the unavoidable suspense. We'd talked and FaceTimed countless times since our first dates, but this was all new and different. And a bit strange.

We were both thinking the same things. *Is it going to translate? To another continent?*

And what if it doesn't?

I asked about the flight. She laughed about the Air Botswana crew. They were big fans of *Suits*, so they'd asked her to pose for a photo.

Yay, I said, thinking: Shit. If one member of the crew posted that photo, the cat would be out of the bag.

We all jumped into a three-bench truck, Mike driving, my bodyguards trailing, and set off. Straight into the sun. After an hour of tarmac roads, we were facing four hours of dirt tracks. To make the time go faster I pointed out every flower, plant, bird. *That's a francolin. That's a hornbill. It's like Zazu from* The Lion King. *That's a lilac-breasted roller, and he seems to be doing his mating display.*

After a respectful period of time, I held her hand.

Next, when the road got flatter, I ventured a kiss.

Just as we both remembered.

My bodyguards, fifty meters behind us, pretended not to see.